

New Zealand Urban Farm Animal Welfare Plan

1. Legal Obligations & The "Five Freedoms"

In New Zealand, the **Animal Welfare Act 1999** dictates that the person in charge (the Teacher) must ensure the physical, health, and behavioural needs of all animals are met. This includes:

- Proper and sufficient food and water.
- Adequate shelter.
- The opportunity to display normal patterns of behaviour.
- Appropriate physical handling.
- Protection from, and rapid diagnosis of, injury and disease.

2. Chickens (Layer Hens)

Aligns with the Code of Welfare: Layer Hens.

- **Housing:** Must be a "predator-proof" coop (ferrets, stoats, cats and stray dogs). On-farm slaughter or "culling" must follow the **2018 Regulations** (No blunt force to the head unless an emergency).
- **Space:** If free-range, must have access to a shaded outdoor area. Indoor stocking density must not exceed the Code's minimums (approx. 7–9 birds per m squared for barn systems).
- **Environment:** Must have a **scratching area**, **perches** (min 15cm per hen), and a **secluded nest box** with suitable substrate.
- **Health:** Daily checks for "Mite" or "Lice" infestations. NZ-specific biosecurity: Ensure no contact with wild birds to prevent avian disease.

3. Sheep

Aligns with the Code of Welfare: Sheep and Beef Cattle.

- **Husbandry:** * **Shearing:** Must be done at least annually to prevent heat stress and wool blindness.
 - **Flystrike:** In NZ summers, daily checks are mandatory. Prevention (drenching/jetting) must be recorded in the Farm Log.
- **Management:** * **Tail Docking/Castration:** If performed on-farm, must comply with the **Care and Procedures Regulations 2018** (pain relief is required for animals over 6 months; however, for a school farm, this should only be done by a vet or competent professional).
- **Feed:** Access to mineral licks to account for NZ soil deficiencies (e.g., Selenium/Cobalt).

4. Geese

Aligns with SPCA NZ Guidelines and General Poultry Standards.

- **Water Needs:** Unlike chickens, geese **must** have access to "open water" (a pond or trough) deep enough to submerge their heads to prevent eye infections and allow for preening.
- **Behaviour:** Known as "sentinel birds" in NZ; they need space to forage. Avoid keeping a lone goose; they require the companionship of their own kind or other waterfowl.
- **Handling:** Must **never** be caught or carried by the wings or legs (a breach of the Animal Welfare Act). They must be supported under the body.

5. Honey Bees (Apiary)

Aligns with the National American Foulbrood (AFB) Pest Management Plan.

- **Legal Registration:** All hives must be registered with **Management Agency National AFB PMP**. The school must have an assigned **Registration Number** displayed on the hives.
- **AFB Checks:** The hive must be inspected for **American Foulbrood (AFB)** at least once a year by a person with a "Category 2" pass or an ADR (Annual Disease Return).
 - *Note:* If AFB is found, NZ law requires the hive to be destroyed (burnt) within 7 days.
- **Varroa Management:** Mandatory treatment (organic or chemical) twice a year (Spring/Autumn) to manage Varroa Mite levels, which are endemic in NZ.

NZ Compliance Checklist (Teacher/Manager Only)

Requirement	NZ Regulation / Code	Status
AFB Registration	Biosecurity Act / AFB PMP	[] Registered
Pain Relief	Care & Procedures Regs 2018	[] On-site/Vet Access
Water Quality	Animal Welfare Act s10	[] Daily Check

Feed Records	Biosecurity / Food Act	[] Logged
Emergency Kill	Care & Procedures Regs 2018	[] Protocol Ready

Emergency Contacts (New Zealand)

- **Farm Vet:** Vet Life - Murrays - 03 489 5540
- **MPI Animal Welfare Hotline:** 0800 00 83 33 (To report serious concerns)
- **AFB Management Agency:** 0800 AFB PMP (0800 232 767)